

By 1992, early users of the Web were navigating through pages that had HTTP links or hypertext menus presented as a file system. Since the number of new pages was growing rapidly, users bookmarked popular directory pages such as <http://info.cern.ch/>, or NCSA's "What's New" page. The graphical browser gap was filled in April 1992 with the release of Erwise and ViolaWWW in May. These browsers could view embedded graphics and animation, and paraphrase scripting code. The release of the Mosaic browser in 1993 helped revolutionise the browsing experience.

The first International WWW conference was held at CERN in May 1994. It was agreed that the Web protocol and code could be used by anyone for free. The World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) was founded in September 1994, with Tim Berners-Lee as its founder.

The years 1996 to 2000 saw a dramatic rise of the Web where many companies were starting to offer commercial services—till the 2001 "dot-com bubble" burst.

1991: Enter Linux

June: Pretty Good Privacy

Philip Zimmermann offered Pretty Good Privacy, or PGP, an encryption program, for free download. It offered very high levels of encryption that almost equalled the best proprietary encryption systems. PGP became, and still continues to be, a popular system to encrypt data like e-mail before transmission over the Internet. Zimmermann was motivated to create his program due to the US government move to make all encryption device manufacturers create special "trap doors" in their devices that would allow an encrypted communication, either voice or data, to be accessible in the unencrypted form. The government move was defeated shortly after PGP was made public.